Reading List: Payments for Ecosystem Services (RCTs)

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I. PES & Deforestation: Landmark RCTs

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1. Jayachandran, S., de Laat, J., Lambin, E.F. & Stanton, C. (2017). "Cash for Carbon: A Randomized Controlled Trial of Payments for Ecosystem Services to Reduce Deforestation." *Science*, 357(6348), 267–273.
   Link
2. Ferraro, P.J. & Kiss, A. (2002). "Direct Payments to Conserve Biodiversity." *Science*, 298(5599), 1718–1719.
   Link
3. Jayachandran, S. (2013). "Liquidity Constraints and Deforestation: The Limitations of Payments for Ecosystem Services." *AER*, 103(3), 309–313.
   Link

I. PES & Deforestation (cont.)

4. Izquierdo-Tort, S., Jayachandran, S. & Saavedra, A. (2024). "Redesigning Payments for Ecosystem Services to Increase Cost-Effectiveness." *Nature Communications*, 15, 3587. Link

5. Jack, B.K. (2013). "Private Information and the Allocation of Land Use Subsidies in Malawi." *AEJ: Applied*, 5(3), 113–135. Link

II. PES Design & Mechanism

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1. Jack, B.K., Kousky, C. & Sims, K.R.E. (2008). "Designing Payments for Ecosystem Services: Lessons from Previous Experience with Incentive-Based Mechanisms." *PNAS*, 105(28), 9465–9470.
   Link
2. Ferraro, P.J. & Simpson, R.D. (2002). "The Cost-Effectiveness of Conservation Payments." *Land Economics*, 78(3), 339–353.
   Link
3. Engel, S., Pagiola, S. & Wunder, S. (2008). "Designing Payments for Environmental Services in Theory and Practice: An Overview of the Issues." *Ecological Economics*, 65(4), 663–674.
   Link

II. PES Design & Mechanism (cont.)

4. Wunder, S. (2005). "Payments for Environmental Services: Some Nuts and Bolts." *CIFOR Occasional Paper* No. 42.
   Link
5. Alix-Garcia, J.M. & Wolff, H. (2014). "Payment for Ecosystem Services from Forests." *Annual Review of Resource Economics*, 6, 361–380.
   Link

III. PES & Poverty Alleviation

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1. Alix-Garcia, J.M., McIntosh, C., Sims, K.R.E. & Welch, J.R. (2013). "The Ecological Footprint of Poverty Alleviation: Evidence from Mexico's Oportunidades Program." *REStat*, 95(2), 417–435.
   Link
2. Sims, K.R.E. (2010). "Conservation and Development: Evidence from Thai Protected Areas." *JDE*, 94(2), 94–107.
   Link
3. Robalino, J.A. & Pfaff, A. (2013). "Ecopayments and Deforestation in Costa Rica: A Nationwide Analysis of PSA's Initial Years." *Land Economics*, 89(3), 432–448.
   Link

III. PES & Poverty Alleviation (cont.)

4. Pagiola, S., Arcenas, A. & Platais, G. (2005). "Can Payments for Environmental Services Help Reduce Poverty? An Exploration of the Issues and the Evidence to Date from Latin America." *World Development*, 33(2), 237–253.
   Link
5. Jayachandran, S. (2022). "How Much Should We Trust Difference-in-Differences Estimates? Evidence from the PES Literature." *Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists*, 9(5), 837–867.
   Link

IV. PES & Spillovers

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1. Alix-Garcia, J.M., Shapiro, E.N. & Sims, K.R.E. (2012). "Forest Conservation and Slippage: Evidence from Mexico's National Payments for Ecosystem Services Program." *Land Economics*, 88(4), 613–638.
   Link

2. Robalino, J., Sandoval, C., Barton, D.N., Chacon, A. & Pfaff, A. (2015). "Evaluating the Impact of Payments for Environmental Services on Deforestation in Costa Rica." *PLoS ONE*, 10(9), e0138529.
   Link

3. Honey-Rosés, J., López-García, J., Rissman, A.R. & Méndez, P. (2018). "Does Payment for Ecosystem Services Reduce Deforestation? Evidence from a Quasi-Experimental Study in Mexico." *Journal of Environmental Management*, 207, 71–79.
   Link

IV. PES & Spillovers (cont.)

4. Pfaff, A., Robalino, J., Lima, E., Sandoval, C. & Diego, L. (2013). "Governance, Location and Avoided Deforestation from Protected Areas: Greater Restrictions Can Have Lower Impact, Due to Differences in Location." *World Development*, 55, 7–20.
   Link

5. Arriagada, R.A., Ferraro, P.J., Sills, E.O., Pattanayak, S.K. & Cordero-Sancho, S. (2012). "Do Payments for Environmental Services Affect Forest Cover? A Farm-Level Evaluation from Costa Rica." *Conservation Biology*, 26(6), 1113–1123.
   Link

V. PES & Additionality

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1. Ferraro, P.J. & Pattanayak, S.K. (2006). "Money for Nothing? The Impact of Payments for Environmental Services on Deforestation in Costa Rica." *PLoS ONE*, 1(1), e9.
   Link

2. Pattanayak, S.K., Wunder, S. & Ferraro, P.J. (2010). "Show Me the Money: Do Payments Supply Environmental Services in Developing Countries?" *Review of Environmental Economics and Policy*, 4(2), 254–274.
   Link

3. Sims, K.R.E., Alix-Garcia, J.M., Shapiro-Garza, E., Fine, L., Radeloff, V.C., Aronson, G., Castillo, S., Ramirez, R. & Kelley, C. (2014). "Improving Environmental and Social Targeting through Adaptive Management in Mexico's Payments for Hydrological Services Program." *Journal of Environmental Management*, 145, 108–119.
   Link

V. PES & Additionality (cont.)

4. Wunder, S., Engel, S. & Pagiola, S. (2008). "Taking Stock: A Comparative Analysis of Payments for Environmental Services Programs in Developed and Developing Countries." *Ecological Economics*, 65(4), 834–852.
   Link

5. Samii, C., Lisiecki, M., Kulkarni, P., Paler, L. & Chavis, L. (2014). "Effects of Payment for Environmental Services and Decentralized Forest Management on Deforestation and Poverty in Low- and Middle-Income Countries." *Campbell Systematic Reviews*, 10(1), 1–95.
   Link

VI. PES & Behavioral Mechanisms

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1. Jack, B.K. (2009). "Upstream-Downstream Transactions and Watershed Externalities: Experimental Evidence from Kenya." *Ecological Economics*, 68(6), 1813–1824.
   Link
2. Narloch, U., Pascual, U. & Drucker, A.G. (2012). "Collective Action Dynamics under External Rewards: Experimental Insights from Andean Farming Communities." *World Development*, 40(10), 2096–2107.
   Link
3. Kaczan, D., Swallow, B.M. & Adamowicz, W.L. (2013). "Designing a Payments for Ecosystem Services (PES) Program to Reduce Deforestation in Tanzania: An Assessment of Payment Approaches." *Ecological Economics*, 95, 20–30.
   Link

VI. PES & Behavioral Mechanisms (cont.)

4. Handberg, Ø. & Angelsen, A. (2019). "Pay Little, Get Little: Why Some PES Programs Fail." *World Development*, 122, 401–413. Link

5. Costedoat, S., Koetse, M., Corbera, E. & Pagiola, S. (2024). "Cash Only? A Randomized Controlled Trial of Payment Modalities for Ecosystem Services." *JEEM*, 131, 102913. Link

VII. PES & Climate Policy

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1. Jayachandran, S., de Laat, J., Lambin, E.F. & Stanton, C. (2017). "Cash for Carbon: A Randomized Trial of PES to Reduce Deforestation." *Science*, 357(6348), 267–273.
   Link
2. Greenstone, M. & Jack, B.K. (2015). "Envirodevonomics: A Research Agenda for a Young Field." *JEL*, 53(1), 5–42.
   Link
3. Buntaine, M.T., Greenstone, M., He, G., Liu, M., Wang, S. & Zhang, B. (2024). "Does the Squeaky Wheel Get More Grease? Citizen Participation and Environmental Governance in China." *AER*, 114(3), 815–850.
   Link

VII. PES & Climate Policy (cont.)

4. He, G., Wang, S. & Zhang, B. (2020). "Watering Down Environmental Regulation in China." *QJE*, 135(4), 2135–2185. Link
5. Greenstone, M., He, G., Jia, R. & Liu, T. (2022). "Can Technology Solve the Principal-Agent Problem? Evidence from China's War on Air Pollution." *AER: Insights*, 4(1), 54–70. Link

VIII. PES & Long-run Sustainability

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1. Ferraro, P.J., Lawlor, K., Mullan, K.L. & Pattanayak, S.K. (2012). "Forest Figures: Ecosystem Services Valuation and Policy Evaluation in Developing Countries." *Review of Environmental Economics and Policy*, 6(1), 20–44.
   Link
2. Wunder, S. (2013). "When Payments for Environmental Services Will Work for Conservation." *Conservation Letters*, 6(4), 230–237.
   Link
3. Ezzine-de-Blas, D., Wunder, S., Ruiz-Pérez, M. & del Pilar Moreno-Sanchez, R. (2013). "Global Patterns in the Implementation of Payments for Environmental Services." *PLoS ONE*, 8(9), e72669.
   Link

VIII. PES & Long-run Sustainability (cont.)

4. Salas, P.C., Alix-Garcia, J.M. & Sims, K.R.E. (2023). "Agricultural Subsidies and Forest Conservation: Evidence from Mexico." *Environment and Development Economics*, 28(3), 251–278.
   Link

5. Börner, J., Baylis, K., Corbera, E., Ezzine-de-Blas, D., Honey-Rosés, J., Persson, U.M. & Wunder, S. (2017). "The Effectiveness of Payments for Environmental Services." *World Development*, 96, 359–374.
   Link

Thank You

Questions & Discussion

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